

AI optimization for Search

 Microsoft Advertising



AI optimization: Why now

Helping you stay ahead of the curve as Search evolves toward more AI-driven experiences.

REACH

Search is evolving, and every day brings new intent-driven queries we've never seen before. Advertisers need smarter solutions to reach them.

RELEVANCE

Traditional keywords and ads struggle to stay relevant in the face of new trends, long-tail queries, and emerging Search experiences.

RESULTS

Microsoft AI can help you connect with new customers throughout their journey and deliver ads that drive stronger results – without adding manual work.

AI optimization: What you gain

This optional campaign toggle helps your Search campaigns deliver greater **reach**, more **relevance**, and stronger **results**—all powered by Microsoft AI.

01

Expand reach beyond your keyword list with AI-powered search term matching that uses your provided content to uncover incremental queries and conversion opportunities.

02

Create relevant, personalized creative at scale through dynamic text customization, ensuring relevance without manual overhead.

03

Optimize destinations for better results by intelligently expanding final URLs and routing traffic to the most relevant landing page, improving conversion rates and user experience.

Product overview

AI optimization is an **optional** Search campaign feature that uses the best of Microsoft AI to dynamically match ads to relevant searches by using advertiser-provided content and real-time signals.

Microsoft Advertising

Contoso US (123456789)

Search

Monika Kane

Campaigns > Create

Create search campaign

Campaign settings

AI optimization

Keywords

Create ad

Bid & Budget

Summary

AI optimization



Boost your search performance with AI

Add AI capabilities only where you need them.

 Surface in highly relevant searches with AI-generated ads from your landing pages, keywords, and creative assets.

 Keep ads fresh and impactful with optimized delivery based on user intent and engagement signals.

 Gain clarity and confidence with access to detailed insights and AI performance reports.

Enable AI-powered optimization for your campaign

Asset optimization

Combine your assets with AI-generated ones to maximize your ad performance.

Text customization

Use text from your website, landing pages, ads, and provided assets to create customized ad copy.

Final URL expansion

Send traffic to the most relevant URLs on your website when it's likely to result in better performance. Requires text customization to be turned on to ensure ad copy matches landing page.

Exclude some URLs

Search term matching

Microsoft AI uses additional keywords from your landing pages and assets to surface ads on more relevant searches.

Use search term matching for this campaign.

Back

Next

Cancel

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Reporting

You'll have full visibility into how AI optimization is driving performance in your campaigns – including assets, keywords, search terms, and final URLs.

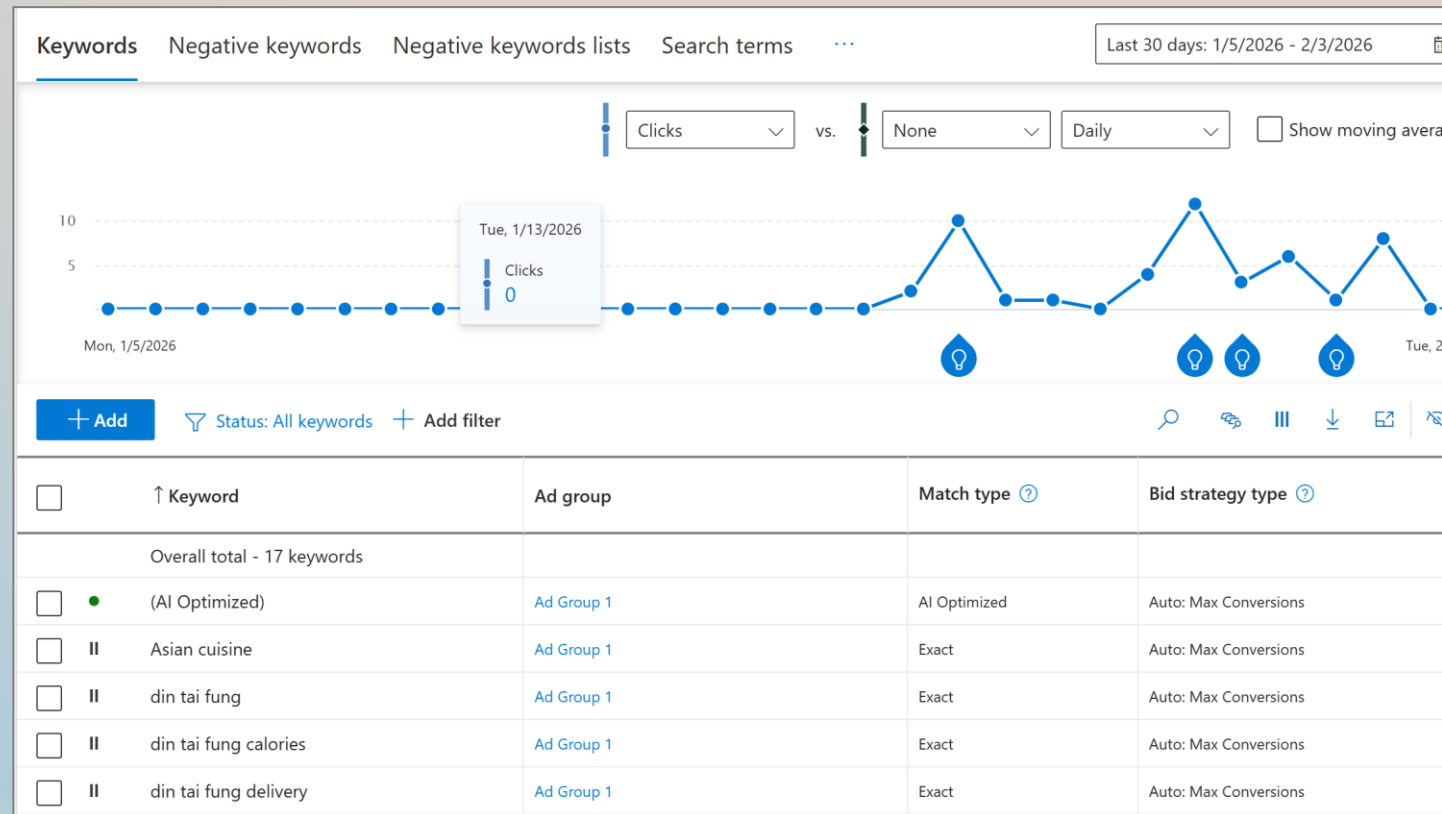
Creative asset reporting

Assets						
Last 30 days: 1/5/2026 - 2/3/2026						
Asset performance is updated once daily and available for the last 30 days. Changes you make to assets will not be reflected in real time. Note: You can only see reports for assets that have had at least one impression. + Add filter Download						
☐	Asset	Asset type	Used by	Pinned by	Source	
☐	Din Tai Fung Official Site	Headline	1 ad	None	Auto-generated	
☐	Share the joy of Din Tai Fung	Headline	4 ads	None	Auto-generated	
☐	Don't miss out on our exclusive events, where tradition meets culinary innovation!	Description	1 ad	None	Advertiser provided	
☐	Savor Unique Soup Dumplings	Headline	1 ad	None	Advertiser provided	
☐	Exclusive Dishes Await You	Headline	1 ad	None	Advertiser provided	
☐	Savor Our Rich Heritage!	Headline	1 ad	None	Advertiser provided	
☐	Order {Keyword:DTF} Online	Headline	1 ad	None	Advertiser provided	

Reporting

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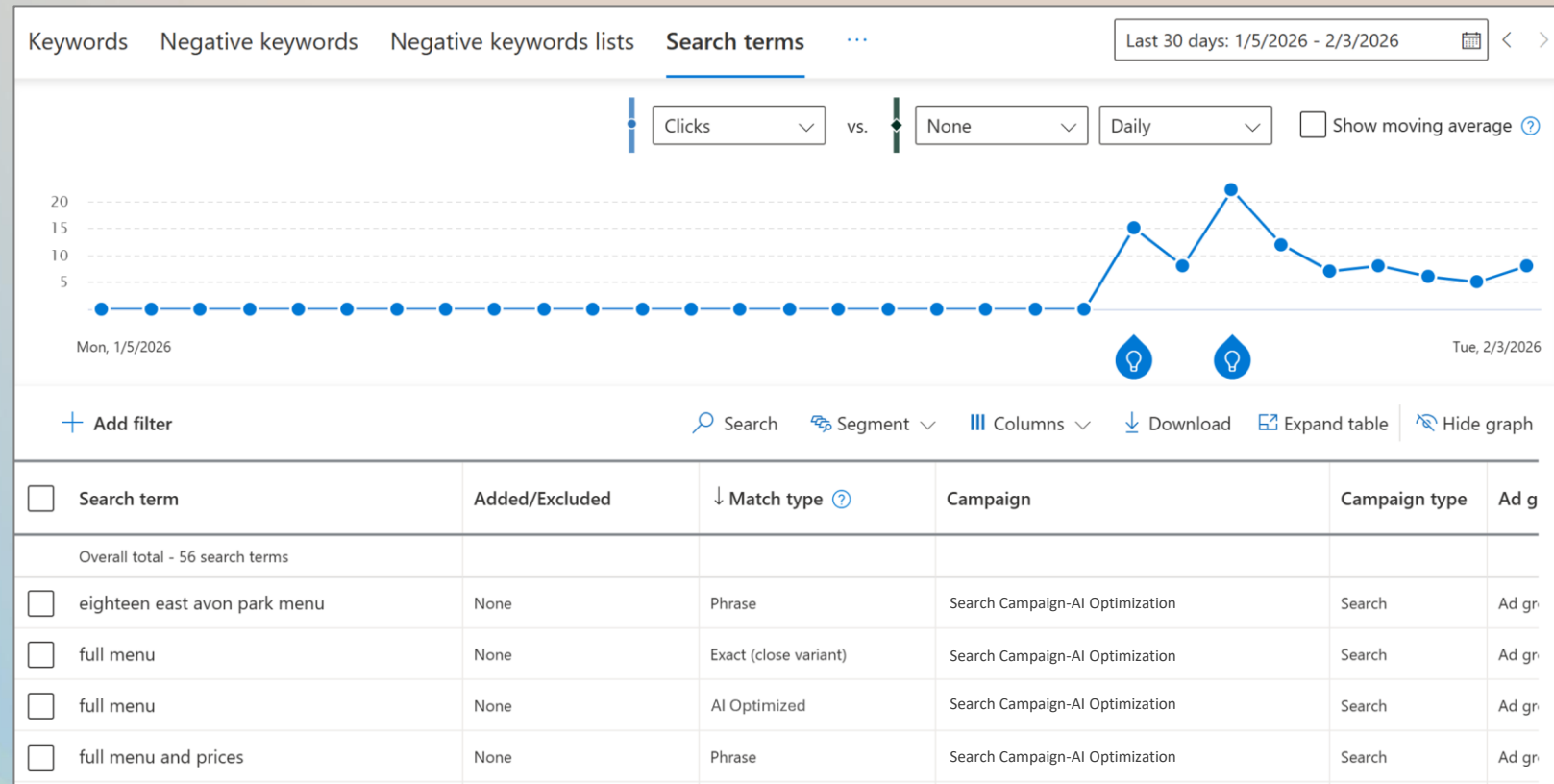
Keyword reporting



Reporting

You'll have full visibility into how AI optimization is driving performance in your campaigns – including assets, keywords, search terms, and final URLs.

Search term reporting



Search Experiments with AI optimization

Set up and run a Search Experiment to statistically measure the performance lift of enabling AI optimization for your Search campaign.

Experiments

Create an experiment

An experiment is a duplicate version of a campaign that uses a portion of the original campaign's budget and traffic.

Subsequent changes to your original campaign's settings (excluding its budget) won't be applied to this experiment.

Select search campaign ?

Search Campaign 

Experiment name ?

Search Campaign-AI Optimization Experiment

Start date ?

3/1/2026

End date

☐ None

☒ 4/30/2026

Experiment split ?

50

%

(Original campaign budget: USD 20/day)

Advanced options

Split option ?

☐ Search-based

☒ Cookie-based

Save

Cancel

Product timeline

MARCH 2ND, 2026

Closed pilot begins

- *MAP and API supported*
- *Google Import supported*
- *External documentation ready (Help Center, API)*

MARCH AND BEYOND

Post-launch support

- *High-demand features to be added based on your ongoing feedback*

FEATURES

Search term matching
Text customization
Final URL expansion
Advertiser experiments

FEATURES

Brand inclusions & exclusions
Guardrails for asset automation
Unified E2E reporting view

Product availability

	STATUS	MARKETS	ENTRY POINTS	DEVICE	TRAFFIC
AI OPTIMIZATION	Closed pilot	Global (excl. China)	Online	All devices	Search (incl. Search Workflows)

Next steps

Overview of how to onboard your account for the AI optimization pilot.

01

Let your Microsoft account team know you're interested in testing AI optimization.

02

Ensure conversion tracking is set up in your account.

03

Make sure you're recording at least 30 conversions per month.

04

Double-check that your campaigns aren't budget constrained.

05

Enable the campaign-level toggle and turn on all relevant settings for AI optimization.

Frequently Asked Questions

The following questions address common concerns raised in pilot discussions.

QUESTION

What does AI optimization do – and what problems does it solve?

ANSWER

AI optimization is an **optional** feature layer for Search campaigns that uses Microsoft AI to dynamically match ads to relevant searches, personalize creative assets, and intelligently route users to the most relevant landing page on your website. It can help you:

- Reach more high-intent customers.
- Deliver personalized ad experiences at scale.
- Improve campaign reach, efficiency and conversion rates.
- Get better campaign outputs for your time investment.
- Maintain transparency and control with future brand inclusion and exclusion tools.

QUESTION

How does AI optimization differ from Google's AI Max?

ANSWER

AI optimization is Microsoft's equivalent to Google's AI Max—but **they aren't identical**.

Google AI Max expands matching and creative automation using Google's signals. AI optimization does something similar, but with the benefit of Microsoft's unique first-party data from Bing, Edge, and LinkedIn, plus more built-in transparency and guardrails.

Both improve reach and relevance, but our offering is designed for advertisers who want automation without losing insight or control over search-only traffic.

QUESTION

What features are found in AI optimization versus Google's AI Max?

Feature	Google AI Max	Microsoft AI Optimization
Core automation <i>(Search term matching, text customization, final URL expansion)</i>	✓	✓
Keyword reporting	✓	✓
Search term reporting	⚠	✓
Asset reporting <i>(Auto vs. provided)</i>	✗	✓
Landing page and asset reporting	✓	✓
Conversion-based bidding	✓	✓
Portfolio bidding	✓	✓
Ad group-level controls	✓	✗
Brand inclusions & exclusions	✓	⌚
Brand guidelines	✓	⌚
Term exclusions for asset generation	✓	⌚
Pinned asset support	⚠	⚠

QUESTION

How does AI optimization differ from Performance Max?

ANSWER

AI optimization is an optional feature layer that brings automation into standard Search campaigns, whereas Performance Max is a cross-channel campaign type. AI optimization is designed to expand matching, personalize creative, and route users to the most relevant landing page, all while maintaining control and transparency. It is not a new campaign type like Performance Max, nor is it a “black box.” It augments Search campaigns rather than replacing them.

If you’re mainly focused on Search and are looking for a balance of control and automation, AI optimization is ideal for your Search campaigns. For maximum reach and automation across all of Microsoft’s channels – including Search – use Performance Max.

QUESTION

How can I test the impact of AI optimization?

ANSWER

We recommend you try using an experiment, which will be supported at launch. Follow these steps to set one up:

- Create a Search Experiment and select the Search campaign you want to test with AI optimization.
- Launch the experiment and let it run for up to 4 weeks to allow the cloned Search campaign to ramp up.
- For the cloned Search campaign, go into the campaign's settings and enable AI optimization.
- You can end the experiment at any time. If the experiment shows a positive lift, you can apply it to either your original or cloned campaign.

QUESTION

What bidding strategies are supported?

ANSWER

AI optimization currently supports conversion-based bid strategies at the individual campaign level, such as Maximize Conversions (with Target CPA) and Maximize Conversion Value (with Target ROAS). It does not support enhanced CPC, manual bidding, or click-based bid strategies.

In addition, AI optimization is not recommended for campaigns using portfolio bid strategies during the pilot due to how it may affect measurement and campaign optimization behaviors.



Thank you



Appendix

The following slides cover common implementation and control questions. Full details are available in the main FAQ.

QUESTION

Why are we calling it “AI optimization” rather than “AI Max”?

ANSWER

We were deliberate in choosing AI optimization because it gives us the flexibility to lead with our product strategy rather than mirror what Google brings to market.

While Google’s “AI Max” is one reference point, adopting the same label would anchor expectations to their feature set and roadmap—something we want to avoid as we continue to differentiate on control, transparency, and search-specific innovation.

QUESTION

Will enabling AI optimization will have any impact on my eligibility or likelihood to show within Copilot?

ANSWER

AI optimization does not currently influence Copilot eligibility or ranking. Your ads' ability to serve in Copilot is driven by the same factors that influence delivery across Microsoft surfaces today — such as campaign type, relevance, Ad Rank, and available formats.

AI optimization focuses on improving Search performance by expanding matching, enhancing creative relevance, and selecting stronger landing pages. While these improvements may indirectly help your campaigns become more competitive overall, there is no dedicated prioritization, eligibility boost, or guaranteed increase in Copilot impressions tied to enabling the feature.

QUESTION

How will Google Import work with AI optimization?

ANSWER

Google Import will bring over your AI Max campaign-level settings 1:1 with their corresponding AI optimization features. However, there are specific things to note here:

1. For pilot-enabled accounts: if you use scheduled Google Imports and have Google AI Max enabled in the source account, **AI optimization will be enabled after the next import sync**. Advertisers are not otherwise automatically opted in to AI optimization.
2. Google AI Max's search term matching feature can also work at the ad group level. **If a single ad group has this feature enabled, the entire campaign will inherit that setting**. You'll have the option to turn it off while importing if you wish to do so.

Additional questions

Answers to common technical questions you may have.

Can I still use negative keywords?

Yes. You'll retain standard control of your Search traffic via negative keywords. Existing negatives won't be overridden and can still be used as a way of removing less relevant traffic.

What controls do I retain, and what do I give up?

You'll still have control over your targeting preferences via negatives and placement exclusions, but we'll expand your keywords, optimize creative and redirect users to optimal landing pages to increase conversion uplift.

How are pinned assets handled?

We will not honor pinned assets when traffic redirection is enabled, as doing so can lead to a mismatch in landing page and ad copy that could negatively impact performance.

Why can I not final URL expansion without text customization?

Optimizing ad assets based on the content of your website is key to delivering a cohesive experience – your existing, static assets may not work as well with an optimized landing page.

Experiments

How to set up and run a Search Experiment for AI optimization.

01

Create a Search Experiment and select the Search campaign you want to test with AI optimization. As part of the experiment creation process, we will create a clone of the selected Search campaign.

02

Before making any changes to the newly cloned Search campaign, launch the experiment and let it run for up to 4 weeks to allow the cloned Search campaign to ramp up and achieve similar performance and delivery as your original Search campaign.

03

For the cloned Search campaign, go into the campaign settings and enable AI optimization. Let the experiment run over the next several weeks and review the experiment scorecard results during this period.

04

You may end the experiment at any time. If the experiment results show a performance lift for the cloned Search campaign with AI optimization enabled, you may apply the experiment either to the original Search campaign or to a new Search campaign.

05

For more info:

[Discover the possibilities with experiments](#)

[Examples and tips for working with experiments](#)

Closed pilot – is this a fit?

Initial participants will be selected from our target list, but additional hand-raisers may be accepted based on the following criteria:

Account maturity

Active search campaigns with room to grow.

Data readiness

Conversion tracking implemented and verified, getting >30 conversion per month.

Automation

Running broad match, DSA, and / or automated bidding. Not currently running Performance Max.

Markets & verticals

Initial rollout markets and verticals confirmed with your Microsoft team.

Participation

Willingness to test, share performance readouts, review weekly learnings and apply recommendations.

If so:

Your Microsoft team can confirm eligibility and next steps.